



# Guide for Referring Physicians

Fixation protocols, requirements by study type, turnaround times, and coordination with our anatomic pathology laboratory.

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[www.susanavighi.com.ar](http://www.susanavighi.com.ar)

## REFERRAL WORKFLOW

# From collection to report

Four steps, designed to minimize delays and ensure full traceability of every sample received.

## 01 Request

Fill out the form with patient data, presumptive diagnosis, prior studies, and the referring physician's details.

## 02 Sample fixation

10% buffered formalin at a 10:1 ratio to tissue volume. Container labeled with the patient's name and ID number.

## 03 Shipping or pickup

Free pickup within Buenos Aires City and Greater Buenos Aires, coordinated by phone. We also receive shipments from anywhere in the country.

## 04 Receipt and traceability

Each sample receives a unique tracking code, and a receipt confirmation is sent to the referring physician.

**IMPORTANT** — For any questions about fixation, transport, or turnaround times, contact our medical coordination team before sending the sample.

## REQUIREMENTS BY STUDY TYPE

# Sample preparation

**Needle / endoscopic biopsy**

- 10% buffered formalin
- Labeled with name and ID number
- Request form with precise anatomical location
- Attach endoscopy report if applicable

**Surgical specimen**

- Immediate fixation in 10% formalin (10:1 ratio)
- Do not section before shipping unless instructed
- Request form with complete clinical and surgical data
- Arrange pickup within 24 hours

**Gynecologic cytology (Pap smear)**

- Smear on a labeled slide
- Fixed with cytology spray or 96° alcohol
- Clinical data: LMP, hormone therapy, relevant history

**Fine-needle aspiration (FNA)**

- Air-dried smears (Diff-Quick) and fixed smears (Papanicolaou)
- Material in liquid medium for cell block if applicable
- Request form with location, size, and ultrasound findings

**Intraoperative (frozen section) biopsy**

- Coordinate in advance by phone
- Fresh, unfixed sample in a sterile container
- Immediate transport to the laboratory

**Molecular studies / complex IHC**

- Sample fixed in 10% formalin (minimum 6 h, maximum 48 h)
- Paraffin block with representative material
- Request form specifying required markers

AVERAGE TURNAROUND TIME

Business days from receipt

| Study                | Estimated time  |
|----------------------|-----------------|
| Pap smear            | 3 business days |
| Biopsy               | 6 business days |
| Immunohistochemistry | 7 business days |
| Biopsy with IHC      | 9 business days |

More complex studies (molecular biology, special techniques) may require additional time.

## MEDICAL COORDINATION

# Let's talk directly

**Phone lines**

(5411) 4551-7752 · (5411) 4551-7267 · (5411) 2035-9667

**Referral coordination**

anatomia.patologica@susanavighi.com.ar

**Service requests**

solicituddeservicio@susanavighi.com.ar

**Address**

Concepción Arenal 3732, Buenos Aires, C1427EKH, Argentina

**Business hours**

Monday to Friday, 8:00 AM to 8:00 PM

This guide summarizes the information published at [susanavighi.com.ar/derivantes](https://susanavighi.com.ar/derivantes). In the event of protocol changes, the version on the website takes precedence over printed copies.